

AI Use Case Registry

Standard operating template for documenting, reviewing, approving, and monitoring organizational AI use cases.

Prepared For	{{COMPANY_NAME}}
Version / Effective Date	v1.0 {{EFFECTIVE_DATE}}

Purpose This registry is the system of record for all material AI use cases in the organization. It helps leadership see what AI is being used, by whom, for what purpose, at what risk level, and under what approval status.

Use this template as a controlled document and update it whenever a new AI use case is proposed, materially changed, approved, retired, or escalated.

1. Registry Overview

The AI Use Case Registry is the organization's central control record for AI usage. It supports visibility, review, accountability, and evidence of governance decisions. Every approved, pending, escalated, prohibited, or retired AI use case should be captured here.

What it captures	Why it matters	Minimum owner	Update trigger
Use case name, business purpose, owner, tool/vendor, data involved, affected users, risk level, review outcome, and monitoring date.	Creates one source of truth. Prevents “we thought someone else was tracking it” syndrome.	Business owner with AI Governance Lead oversight.	New use case, material change, re-review, incident, vendor change, or retirement.

Recommended operating rule:

No material AI use case should go live without being logged in the registry and assigned an owner, a risk rating, and an approval status.

2. Completion Instructions

- Create one row for each distinct AI use case, not one row per employee or per prompt.
- Log both proposed and active use cases so the organization can see its AI pipeline as well as current exposure.
- Where one tool supports multiple materially different use cases, record them separately.
- Update the registry when data types, business purpose, vendor, risk level, or approval status materially change.
- Use the Review Notes and Required Controls fields to document conditions of approval, limitations, or remediation actions.

Status definitions

Status	Meaning	Typical action
Proposed	Submitted and awaiting triage or review.	Complete intake and assign initial risk rating.
Approved	Approved for use under stated conditions.	Operate, monitor, and revalidate as scheduled.
Approved with Conditions	Approved only if listed controls or	Track remediation, guardrails, and

	restrictions are followed.	owner actions.
Escalated	Requires deeper review due to higher risk or uncertainty.	Route to security, privacy, legal, or leadership review.
Rejected / Prohibited	Not approved for organizational use.	Stop or prevent deployment and document rationale.
Retired	No longer in active use.	Keep record for history and audit trail.

3. Required Registry Fields

Use the following field set as the baseline standard. Add columns only when they serve a specific business or regulatory need.

Field	Req.	Description	Example
Use Case ID	Y	Unique identifier for tracking and cross-reference.	AI-UC-001
Use Case Title	Y	Short business-facing name of the AI use case.	Customer email drafting assistant
Business Owner	Y	Named person accountable for the use case outcome.	{{OWNER_NAME}}
Department / Function	Y	Primary function using or sponsoring the use case.	Marketing
Tool / Vendor	Y	AI platform, model, or vendor used.	Microsoft Copilot
Use Case Purpose	Y	What the use case does and why the business wants it.	Draft campaign emails faster
User Population	Y	Who uses it or is affected by it.	Marketing team of 8
Data Types Involved	Y	Main data categories used as inputs or context.	Internal non-public marketing plans
Sensitive / Regulated Data?	Y	Whether personal, confidential, regulated,	No

		or restricted data is involved.	
Customer / Employee Impact	Y	Whether outputs affect customers, employees, or third parties.	Indirect customer impact
Risk Rating	Y	Low, Medium, High, or Critical based on triage criteria.	Medium
Approval Status	Y	Current decision state of the use case.	Approved with Conditions
Required Controls	N	Controls, restrictions, or guardrails attached to approval.	No personal data; human review required
Review Date	Y	Date of latest review or decision.	{{DATE}}
Next Review / Revalidation	Y	Next planned re-review date.	{{DATE}}
Review Notes	N	Concise rationale, issues, escalation notes, or remediation actions.	Permitted only in enterprise tenant

4. Risk Rating Guidance

Use a simple risk-based approach. Small businesses do not need a PhD thesis to decide whether a use case is risky. They need clear triggers and defensible judgment.

Level	Color Cue	Typical indicators	Expected treatment
Low	Green	Internal drafting, summarization, or brainstorming with non-sensitive content.	Fast-track review and registry entry.
Medium	Amber	Internal automation, internal confidential data in approved systems, or non-material decisions.	Security/business review and defined controls.
High	Red	Sensitive data, customer-facing outputs, HR/finance/legal impacts, or significant operational dependence.	Escalated review with privacy, legal, and security input.
Critical	Deep Red	Automated decisions with major impact, regulated use, safety impact, or unresolved vendor/data concerns.	Executive review, enhanced controls, or prohibition.

5. Master Registry Template

Use this page as the formal template. For active operations, the same structure can also be maintained in a spreadsheet or system of record.

Use Case ID	Use Case Title	Owner	Dept.	Tool / Vendor	Purpose	Data Types	Risk	Status	Review Date	Next Review	Required Controls / Notes
{{AI-UC-00X}}	{{Use case title}}	{{Owner}}	{{Dept.}}	{{Vendor}}	{{Business purpose}}	{{Data types}}	{{Risk}}	{{Status}}	{{Date}}	{{Date}}	{{Controls / notes}}

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{{AI-UC-00X}}	{{Use case title}}	{{Owner}}	{{Dept.}}	{{Vendor}}	{{Business purpose}}	{{Data types}}	{{Risk}}	{{Status}}	{{Date}}	{{Date}}	{{Controls / notes}}
{{AI-UC-00X}}	{{Use case title}}	{{Owner}}	{{Dept.}}	{{Vendor}}	{{Business purpose}}	{{Data types}}	{{Risk}}	{{Status}}	{{Date}}	{{Date}}	{{Controls / notes}}
{{AI-UC-00X}}	{{Use case title}}	{{Owner}}	{{Dept.}}	{{Vendor}}	{{Business purpose}}	{{Data types}}	{{Risk}}	{{Status}}	{{Date}}	{{Date}}	{{Controls / notes}}
{{AI-UC-00X}}	{{Use case title}}	{{Owner}}	{{Dept.}}	{{Vendor}}	{{Business purpose}}	{{Data types}}	{{Risk}}	{{Status}}	{{Date}}	{{Date}}	{{Controls / notes}}

Practical tip: If the registry grows beyond a handful of entries, move the live version into a spreadsheet or governance platform. Keep this document as the standard and control reference.

6. Example Entries

These examples show what “good enough” documentation looks like for common SMB use cases.

Use Case ID	Title	Tool	Risk	Status	Notes
AI-UC-001	Internal meeting summary assistant	Microsoft Copilot	Low	Approved	No sensitive personal data. Human review required before external sharing.
AI-UC-002	Customer support response drafting	ChatGPT Enterprise	Medium	Approved with Conditions	Only approved tenant. No payment card or health data. Responses reviewed by agent.
AI-UC-003	Resume screening automation	Third-party HR AI tool	High	Escalated	Potential employment impact. Requires legal/privacy review before rollout.

7. Approval and Control Record

Use this block to evidence ownership of the registry standard itself. Operational approval of individual use cases should be captured in the registry rows and supporting workflow.

Document Owner	{{NAME / TITLE}}
Approved By	{{NAME / TITLE}}
Effective Date	{{DATE}}
Review Cycle	At least quarterly during rollout, then annually or upon material change

Template note: Replace bracketed placeholders and adapt terminology to your internal governance model. Keep field names stable over time to support trend analysis and auditability.